

How can this make any sense, does anyone make any money?

You might think that as Linux and the associated open source titles that go with it are free in cost and also free 'as in speech' that this means that there is no money to be had from Linux. Indeed, many companies originally thought that Linux was nothing more than a hobby or a geeks plaything, but this perception has diminished over the years, and with Linux going strong since 1991, it's here to stay. Here are a few reasons why Linux helps businesses and can generate profit over the traditional software business model:

- Linux is one of the most popular and reliable platforms on earth today, it is this basis that has let many companies such as Google and Amazon build from that foundation and leverage it to make solid profit. Every Android mobile phone or tablet uses Linux, all of Amazon's websites use Linux, every Google search is powered by Linux and every Tweet uses Linux at the operating system level.
- Many businesses choose to purchase support contracts to obtain help with their Linux systems, just as they would with a commercial based platform.
- Companies like Intel, who invest heavily into Linux can see the return on their investment rapidly because Linux has the flexibility to allow their newest technologies such as new processors to work straight away via the Open Code/Source model. Typically, Intel would have to wait many months or years to see support fully phased into releases of Windows or MacOS for their latest products.
- In countries like China, up to 70% of all the computers that ship now ship with Linux on them. The vast majority of these computers retain their installation of Linux because the Linux installation allows the user to do what they want to do with their computer, it means no levy for the manufacturers to pay to companies like Microsoft for copies of Windows and therefore cost savings to the customer. This in return has shown a rise in computer purchases and sales at a better margin of profit.
- The majority of companies use Linux for server hosting because it will out-perform its Windows counterparts and will do it at a near zero-cost. This provides a hefty return on investment to the company, and also in turn to their customers. This can be stacked up with other cost-saving methods such as virtualisation, which means that you can have multiple Linux servers all running on one physical server. This reduces costs in the server room on cooling, power and hardware. For many companies across the globe, Linux is therefore a no-brainer.
- Well paid jobs: Linux is big. Really big in enterprise IT today. This means jobs. Hopefully this guide may pique your interest into firstly starting to use Linux as your everyday desktop, but in time, you might decide to get more advanced. See the following links if you need proof!
 - Infoworld: [Why are Linux Professionals in such high demand](#)
 - ZDNet: [Linux and Open Source Jobs are in more demand than ever.](#)
- Finally, Over time, many companies, universities and hobbyists find themselves naturally giving back some things to the Linux community because it helped them with a certain task. This continued cycle of improvement and collaboration spurs this on. You only have to look at open source projects like Wikipedia to see that this cycle works very well. Nobody gets paid to make Wikipedia the best source of information anywhere in the world, but yet people add to it none the less. Linux works in the same way.

Now, visit [Chapter Three](#) to decide on which flavour of Linux you want!

Or, if you need more convincing, why not take a sneaky peek at [Chapter 7](#), where we show the greatest in open source software and detail how Linux helps out with your life on the desktop every day.